MKTG 579: LLM Biz Applications
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Initial Project Proposal

UW Foster MBA RAG-Powered Assistant

What We Are Building

We are building a RAG-powered chatbot assistant for the UW Foster MBA program that helps students plan courses and access program information. The intent is for the Foster MBA program office to eventually maintain the bot by uploading current class syllabi, quarterly class schedules, and provide new course offering one-pagers or syllabi. Students will be able to ask questions about what a class covers, what assignments are required, how the grading rubric is structured, and whether a course fits into their schedule. The assistant will also support recommendations. For example, a student could ask, “I want to go into corporate finance, what electives should I take?” and the system would recommend relevant courses based on course content, skills covered, and the student’s stated goals.

Tools and Main Concepts

The system will use large language models, dynamic retrieval-augmented generation, document parsing, metadata extraction, and semantic search. Syllabi and schedules uploaded by the program office will be processed into searchable chunks and tagged with metadata such as course name, quarter, instructor, meeting time, grading breakdown, and assignment types. A vector database will retrieve the most relevant content for each query, and the LLM will generate responses grounded in those materials. For recommendation questions, the system will combine retrieved course information with lightweight reasoning logic to connect student goals, such as corporate finance, consulting, or product management, to relevant electives. Responses should include citations so users can verify the source material.

Business Justification

MBA students currently need to search across fragmented documents to make course decisions, understand expectations, and plan schedules. That creates friction during registration and quarter planning. A Foster-specific RAG-powered assistant would reduce search time, improve access to information, and provide tailored academic guidance through a single interface. This makes it a strong example of how LLMs can turn unstructured institutional knowledge into a practical decision-support tool.